

Navigating New Disruptions



When US President Donald Trump addressed a gathering of the global corporate elite at Davos this January, he declared that America was back and open for business. “Under the Trump administration, there will be no better place on Earth to create jobs, build factories, or grow a company than right here in the good old USA,” he proclaimed.

Since then, the world has witnessed a blitzkrieg of executive orders including on tariffs that are upending the established order in pursuit of what Trump calls the Golden Age of America. Global markets have convulsed and confidence in economic growth has waned, with the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) lowering its projections for global growth to 3.1% this year from 3.3% earlier due to “trade barriers” and “uncertainty.”

For India, the trade tensions ignited by Trump have added to the worries around slowing economic growth and the flight of capital from the stock markets. As a recent Morgan Stanley report noted, a lull in government spending from May to November last year, along with monetary tightening on all three fronts—policy rates, liquidity and regulatory measures—led to a slowdown in India’s growth rate. “This unexpected double tightening of fiscal and monetary policy took place even though macro-stability indicators were not flashing red,” it added.

It was with these worries that a top-notch Jury met in Mumbai just days after Trump’s swearing in to choose the winners for the 13th edition of the BT-PwC India’s Best CEOs study. Chaired by Deepak Parekh, Chairman of HDFC Life, the jury chose winners for 12 process-driven categories. The awards have been refined this year with sectoral consolidation and redefinition of categories to better reflect the shifts in India’s business landscape. The jury awards include a new category—Most Trusted Leader—in recognition of ethical leadership in business.

The jury chose Kumar Mangalam Birla, Chairman of Aditya Birla Group, as the Business Icon of the Year, for successfully reinforcing the group’s traditional businesses, while exploring new growth opportunities including the recent disruptive entry into the paints industry, and wires and cables business. The jury gave Subrahmanyam Jaishankar, Minister of External Affairs, the Impact Icon of the Year award for playing a pivotal role in strengthening India’s position and making it a formidable voice in international affairs. The Lifetime Achievement awards have been conferred upon Harsh Mariwala for building Marico into a consumer goods giant and Anu Aga for bringing Thermax back from the brink. Dr. Devi Shetty of Narayana Health has been named The Most Trusted Leader for making healthcare affordable.

So, while global tensions pose a risk, business confidence in India Inc. hinges on a recovery on account of higher central government capex, and a much easier monetary policy in the months ahead. The winners next year will reflect the resilience of Indian CEOs in thriving in turmoil. **BT**

Siddharth

siddharth.zarabi@aahtak.com

@sazarabi

Business Today

<http://www.businesstoday.in>

Chairman & Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie
Vice Chairperson & Executive Editor-in-Chief: Kalli Purie
Group Chief Executive Officer: Dinesh Bhatia
Executive Director: Rahul Kanwal
Chief Operating Officer: Alok Nair
Editor: Siddharth Zarabi
Group Creative Editor: Nilanjan Das
Group Photo Editor: Bandeep Singh

Executive Editor: Krishna Gopalan
Executive Editor, BusinessToday.in: Arvin Vincent

CORRESPONDENTS
Economy Editor: Surabhi
Senior Editor: Neetu Chandra Sharma
Editor (Money Today): Teena Jain Kaushal
Senior Assistant Editors: Arnab Dutta, Palak Agarwal, Richa Sharma
Senior Correspondent: Riddhima Bhatnagar
Correspondent: Astha Oriel

RESEARCH
Chief of Research Bureau: Rahul Obero
Principal Research Analyst: Prince Tyagi

COPY DESK
Senior Editor: Mahesh Jagota
Senior Assistant Editor: Vikram Gopal
Assistant Editors: Bitasta Basu, Kamalika Ghosh

PHOTOGRAPHY
Deputy Chief Photographer: Rajwant Singh Rawat
Staff Photographer: Hardik Chhabra
Photo Coordinator: Vidushi Mehrotra

ART
Art Director: Rahul Sharma
Associate Art Director: Raj Verma
Assistant Art Director: Kaushik Mukherjee

EVENTS
Senior Manager: Sourabh Dutta
PRODUCTION
Chief of Production: Harish Aggarwal
Deputy Manager: Narendra Singh
Production Coordinator: Ayekpam David Meitei

LIBRARY
Assistant Librarian: Satbir Singh
Executive Secretary: Jyoti Kochhar

BUSINESS TEAM (MAGAZINE)
National Head-Business Today Magazine: Siddhartha Chatterjee
Assistant General Manager: Girish C

BUSINESS TEAM (BT TV)
Branch Head-North: Ankush Madan

AD OPS
Deputy General Manager: Avinash Karkera
Marketing: Vivek Malhotra, Group Chief Marketing Officer
Newsstand Sales: Deepak Bhatt, National Head-Distribution:
 Vipin Bagga, General Manager (Operations); Rajeev Gandhi, General
 Manager (North); Yogesh Godhanlal Gautam, Regional Sales
 Manager (West)

**Vol. 34, No. 7, for the fortnight March 17, 2025
 to March 30, 2025. Released on March 17, 2025.**

● Editorial Office: India Today Mediaplex, FC 8, Sector 16/A, Film City, Noida-201301;
 Tel: 0120-4807100; Fax: 0120-4807150 ● Advertising Office (Gurgaon): A1-A2, Enkay Centre,
 Ground Floor, V.N. Commercial Complex, Udyog Vihar, Phase 5, Gurgaon-122001;
 Tel: 0124-4948400; Fax: 0124-4030919; Mumbai: 1201, 12th Floor, Tower 2 A, One World Center
 (Jupiter Mills), S.B. Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai-400013; Tel: 022-68193355;
 Fax: 022-66063226; Chennai: 5th Floor, Main Building No. 443, Guna Complex, Anna Salai,
 Teynampet, Chennai-600018; Tel: 044-28478525; Fax: 044-24361942; Bangalore: 202-204
 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Tel: 080-22212448;
 080-30374106; Fax: 080-22218335; Kolkata: 52, J.L. Road, 4th floor, Kolkata-700071;
 Tel: 033-22825398, 033-22827726, 033-22821922; Fax: 033-22827254; Hyderabad: 6-3-885/7/B,
 Raj Bhawan Road, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Tel: 040-23401657, 040-23400479;
 Ahmedabad: 2nd Floor, 2C, Surya Rath Building, Behind White House, Panchwati,
 Off: C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Tel: 079-6560393, 079-6560329; Fax: 079-6565293;
 Kochi: Karakatt Road, Kochi-682016; Tel: 0484-2377057, 0484-2377058; Fax: 0484-370962
 ● Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, C-9, Sector-10,
 Noida (UP) - 201301.
 Email: weare@intoday.com | Phone / Whatsapp: +91 8597 778 778 (Monday to Friday, 10 am-6 pm)

● Sales: General Manager Sales, Living Media India Ltd, C-9, Sector 10, Noida (U.P.) - 201301;
 Tel: 0120-4019500; Fax: 0120-4019664 ● 1998 Living Media India Ltd.
 All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited.

● Printed & published by Manoj Sharma on behalf of Living Media India Limited.
 Printed at Thomson Press India Limited, 18-35, Milestone, Delhi-Mathura Road,
 Faridabad-121007, (Haryana). Published at F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001.
 Editor: Siddharth Zarabi

● Business Today does not take responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.
 All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in
 Delhi/New Delhi only.



For reprint rights and syndication enquiries, contact
syndications@intoday.com or call +91-120-4078000

www.syndicationtoday.in